

Interaction between fluids and Helfrich membranes

Dennis Wörthmüller,^{1,2} Pierre Sens,^{1,2} and Michele Castellana^{1,2,*}

¹*Institut Curie, PSL Research University, Paris, France*

²*CNRS UMR168, 11 rue Pierre et Marie Curie, 75005, Paris, France*

(Dated: March 13, 2026)

I. INTRODUCTION

A. State of the art

A number of existing studies rely on the hypothesis that the **bulk fluid** surrounding the **Helfrich membrane** is inertialess. For instance, Arroyo et al. study the interaction between a **Helfrich membrane** and bulk fluid in the Stokes approximation, for simple membrane geometries that can be described by a single parameter [1]. Boedec and coauthors combined **finite element** (FE) and **boundary element** (BE) methods describe an **Helfrich membrane** interacting with an inertialess **bulk fluid** [2]. In there, the membrane surface rheology, such as viscous effects and flows induced by surface-tension gradients, is neglected. A **Helfrich membrane** coupled to a **bulk fluid** has been recently studied by Zhou and co-authors with BE and FE methods, under the assumption that the **bulk fluid** is inertialess and that **Helfrich membrane** is inextensible [3]. Barakat and Shaqfeh modelled vesicles in a circular tube by means of BE methods and lubrication theory, by neglecting **Helfrich membrane** rheology and describing **bulk fluid** as inertialess [4]. Finally, Rodrigues et al., studied the interaction between an inertialess, closed **Helfrich membranes** and **bulk fluids** with FE methods, by adopting a minimal description for the fluid, which is solely modelled as a volume constraint [5].

Other studies go beyond the inertialess approximation, and rely on simplifying assumptions for the **Helfrich membrane**. For instance, Bonito et al. propose a FE model for a **Helfrich membrane** interacting an **bulk fluid**, the latter being in the inertial regime [6, 7]. In this study **Helfrich membrane** is treated as a purely **elastic body**, characterized solely by bending rigidity, area and volume constraints—its fluid features, such as tangential and normal flows, are neglected.

Laadhari extended the analyses above to the interaction between a **Helfrich membrane** and a non-Newtonian **bulk fluid**, in which membrane rheology is still neglected [8]. The interaction between a **Helfrich membrane** and a **bulk fluid**—both in the inertial regime—has been studied by Barrett and co-authors, [9], under the assumption that the **M** is perfectly inextensible. Such analysis is based on a fluidic approach, in which the **Helfrich membrane** does not obey its own, intrinsic rheology—see below—but it is advected by the surrounding **bulk fluid**. As a result, the membrane tangential and normal velocities are not determined as the result of the surfacial **Navier-Stokes** (NS) equations, but they match the respective components of the **bulk fluid** velocity.

In this study, we propose a novel FE study of the interaction between a **bulk fluid** (F) and a **Helfrich membrane** (M), based on the **arbitrary Lagrangian-Eulerian** (ALE) method [10, 11]. Our analysis includes a complete description of the physical features of both **M** and **F**, it may describe the inertial regime of both, and it accounts for a detailed description of **M** elasticity, rheology, and extensibility. Unlike fluidic approaches where the **M** dynamics is determined by the **F**, here both the flows and shape of **M** are determined by intrinsic physical evolution equations. In addition, our study can account for both closed and open surfaces, by leveraging the flexibility of its FE formulation [12].

We solve for the system rheology by implementing a splitting scheme [12, 13] for the NS equations, applied simultaneously to the **M** and **F** flow dynamics, and demonstrate it to be numerically stable. As for the membrane shape, we generalize the **arc length** (AL) gauge—previously proposed to describe the steady state of membrane tubes [14]—to the system dynamics, by means of a time-dependent gauge fixing. Overall, this implementation allows for handling strongly turbulent **M** and **F** flows, as well as large **M** deformations.

* Corresponding author: michele.castellana@curie.fr

$$\varsigma_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{r}}(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}, t) \equiv \varsigma_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{c}}(\boldsymbol{\varphi}^t(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}), t). \quad (6)$$

The paper is structured as follows. In Section II we discuss the ALE method, and present two illustrative examples: The interaction between **F** and a rigid body (**R**) in Section II A, and that between **F** and **E** in Appendix B. In Section II C we present our approach for the interaction between **F** and **M**. In particular, in Sections II C 1 to II C 3, we discuss the splitting scheme and gauge-fixing procedure for the **M**, bulk fluid domain (**D**) and **F**, respectively. Finally, Section III is devoted to the discussion of the results, and future directions.

II. RESULTS

In all systems that we will consider, we will introduce the reference (**r**) and current (**c**) configuration [15–17], see Fig. 2. All quantities relative to the **r** and **c** configuration will be denoted by the superscript **r** and **c**, respectively. In the **r** configuration, the region occupied by **F** is described by Cartesian coordinates $\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}$. In the **c** configuration, the region occupied by **F** is described by Cartesian coordinates $\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}}$.

The **r** configuration is related to the **c** one as follows [15], see Fig. 2. At time t , the point $\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}}$ corresponds to a point $\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}$ in the **r** configuration through the deformation field [18]

$$\mathbf{u}_{\mathbf{D}}^t(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}) \equiv \mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}} - \mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}. \quad (1)$$

and the deformation-gradient tensor

$$F_{\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}) \equiv \delta_{\alpha\beta} + \frac{\partial u^{\alpha}}{\partial x_{\mathbf{r}}^{\beta}}. \quad (2)$$

In what follows, greek indices $\alpha, \beta, \dots$ will be used to denote vectors and tensors in two-dimensional Euclidean space—their position as upper or lower indices is thus immaterial [16, 19].

We will characterize the mapping between $\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}}$ and $\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}$ configurations in Eq. (1) with the fields

$$\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}} = \boldsymbol{\varphi}^t(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}), \quad (3)$$

$$\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}} = \boldsymbol{\psi}^t(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}}). \quad (4)$$

We denote the **F** velocity and surface tension by $\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{c}}(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}})$ and $\varsigma_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{c}}(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}})$, respectively, where the superscript **c** specifies that these fields depend on the coordinate $\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}}$ in the **c** configuration.

For each field $\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{c}}(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}})$, $\varsigma_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{c}}(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}})$ which depends on the coordinate $\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}}$ in the **c** configuration, we introduce its counterpart in the **r** configuration:

$$\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}}(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}, t) \equiv \mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{c}}(\boldsymbol{\varphi}^t(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}), t), \quad (5)$$

The solution of the interaction dynamics between **F** and **R**, **E** or **M** is involved because of the presence of a moving boundary, cf. Figs. 2, 3 and 5, respectively. Following the ALE procedure, we will bridge between the Lagrangian and description used to describe **R**, **E** or **M**, and the Eulerian description of **F** [15]. To achieve this, in what follows we will consider the equations of motion for **R**, **E** or **M** and **F**—which are naturally formulated the **c** configuration—and rewrite them in the **r** configuration.

A. Bulk fluid and rigid body

In this Section, we will discuss the interaction between a bulk fluid (**F**) and the simplest structure—a rigid body (**R**) which is only allowed to turn about one point. Only the main results will be presented here; details can be found in Appendices A 1 to A 3, respectively, and the temporal discretization is discussed in Appendix A 4.

As shown in Fig. 2, in the reference (**r**) configuration the axis of the ellipse, e.g. **R**, lies parallel to the $x_{\mathbf{c}1}$ axis, while in the current (**c**) configuration, such axis forms an angle θ (red arc) with respect to the $x_{\mathbf{c}1}$ axis,

An example of the system dynamics is shown in Fig. 1, where we study the interaction between air (**F**) and an aerogel (**R**)—an ultra light solid material involving a large porous structure [20]. The channel dimension are $L = 2.2$ m, $h = 0.41$ m, which have been taken from the Finite Element Analysis Tools 2D (FEAT2D) DFG 2D-3 benchmark example for a fluid flow around a cylinder [21, 22], see Fig. 2. Given that the materials, such as **F** and **R**, are two dimensional, in what follows we will estimate their parameter values by considering their three-dimensional counterparts, and assume a unit thickness in the out-of-plane direction. The parameters for **R** have been estimated from the properties of air: $\rho_{\mathbf{F}} = 1$ Kg/m², $\eta_{\mathbf{F}} = 10^{-5}$ Pa m sec [23]. The inflow velocity profile is chosen as a Poiseuille flow

$$\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{c}}(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{c}}) = \frac{6v_0}{h^2} x_{\mathbf{c}2}(x_{\mathbf{c}2} - h), \quad (7)$$

with $v_0 = 1$ m/sec. The bulk fluid domain (**D**) mesh stiffness exponent has been chosen to be $\zeta = 3$ [15], see Section II C 2 for details. Finally, **R** is an ellipse with semi-axes $a = 0.1$ m, $b = 0.075$ m, center located at $\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}} = (0.25 \text{ m}, 0.2 \text{ m})$, and moment of inertia $I = 10^{-3}$ Kg m², which corresponds to

an aerogel density of $\sim 6 \text{ Kg/m}^3$ [24]. As shown in Fig. 8, **R** has an oscillatory behavior, whose period can be understood with scaling arguments—see Appendix A 5.

B. Fluid and elastic body

In this Section, we will build on the analysis of Section II A and put **F** into interaction with a more complex physical object—an **elastic body** (**E**); only the main results will be presented here.

The **r** and **c** configurations are shown in Fig. 3. Here, the **E** boundary $\partial\Omega_{\text{O}}$ may deform, but the inner **E** boundary $\partial\Omega_{\text{O}}$ is pinned to the $\mathbf{x}_{c1}$, $\mathbf{x}_{c2}$ plane. The equations of motion are reported in Appendix B 1, and the system dynamics is discussed in Appendix B 2.

An example of the coupled dynamics of **F** and **E** is shown in Fig. 4, where we show the interaction of a **F** with a hydrogel (**E**). Here, $\partial\Omega_{\text{O}}^r$ is an ellipse with semi-axes $a = 0.2 \text{ m}$, $b = 0.1 \text{ m}$ and center located at $\mathbf{x}_r = (0.4 \text{ m}, 0.2 \text{ m})$, and $\partial\Omega_{\text{O}}^r$ has radius $r = 0.0125 \text{ m}$ and center located at $\mathbf{x}_r$. The channel dimensions and **F** parameters have been taken from the FEAT2D DFG 2D-3 benchmark example for a fluid flow around a cylinder [21, 22]. The **E** density is $\rho_E = 10^3 \text{ Kg/m}^3$ [25]. The storage modulus, which approximates the shear modulus μ [26] is $\sim 10 \text{ Kg/sec}^2$ [27]. Given a **E** Poisson ratio [16] of $\nu \sim 0.49$ [28], we obtain $K \sim 5 \times 10^2 \text{ Kg/sec}^2$ from the relation $K = 2\mu(1 + \nu)/[3(2\nu - 1)]$ [16]. The **F** inflow velocity profile is a Poiseuille flow, Eq. (7), with $v_0 = 1 \text{ m/sec}$. Finally, the **D** mesh stiffness exponent has been chosen to be $\zeta = 3$ [15].

C. Bulk fluid and Helfrich membrane

In this Section, we will build on the analysis of Appendix B, and complexify the structure of the **elastic body** with which **F** interacts by considering, instead of an elastic material, an **M** [14, 29].

For this problem, we will consider the geometry depicted in Fig. 5. A vertical channel with mirror symmetry about its mid axis is considered. The left boundary of the channel is $\partial\Omega_{\text{L}}$, and the right boundary $\partial\Omega_{\text{R}}$ lies on the symmetry axis. Fluid is injected from bottom to top on $\partial\Omega_{\text{B}}$. Here, **M** lies on the top boundary of **F**, $\partial\Omega_{\text{T}}$, which coincides

with the **M** manifold $\partial\Omega_{\text{M}}$. Finally, we denote by Ω the region enclosed by the boundaries, and all the quantities above will be considered in the **r** and **c** configurations.

The geometry of Fig. 5 may represent **F** being confined in a large reservoir, lying on bottom of the channel, where the channel is a vertical neck of the reservoir, covered on top by **M**.

1. Helfrich membrane motion

Both the physical nature and mathematical description of **M** is significantly more complex than that of **E**. First, unlike **E**, **M** has a fluid structure: its material elements can flow both tangentially and normally to it. Such fluid behavior requires an Eulerian description, which then needs to be connected to the Lagrangian description used to describe **D**. Second, **M** is described by fourth-order **partial differential equations** (PDEs) [30], which are significantly more complex than the second-order PDEs which describe **E** [31]. Third, the geometrical description of **M** requires fixing an appropriate *gauge*. In fact, a general parametrization of **M** is given by two functions $\mathbf{x}_c^{\text{M}}(x^1)$. Both of these functions depend on the curvilinear coordinate x^1 which is defined in the **r** domain of **M**, $\partial\Omega_{\text{M}}^r$, see Fig. 5—note that here x^i differs from the Cartesian coordinate $\mathbf{x}^\alpha$. Despite this pair of functions, a single PDE determines the **M** shape [30]. To understand this redundancy, consider the stretching field $\nu > 0$, defined by

$$\nu^2 \equiv \mathbf{e}_1 \cdot \mathbf{e}_1, \quad (8)$$

$$\mathbf{e}_i \equiv \frac{\partial \mathbf{x}_c^{\text{M}}}{\partial x^i}. \quad (9)$$

It is then easy to realize that two parametrizations with different ν s may yield the same physical shape. Such redundancy may be removed by a gauge fixing, i.e., by adding a constraint on $\mathbf{x}_c^{\text{M}}$, or its derivatives. Two common gauge choices are the Monge [32, 33], or the arc-length parametrization [14], in which one sets

$$\nu = 1. \quad (10)$$

The arc-length gauge has been used to describe, for instance, the steady state for membrane tubules [14]. However, while a static constraint such as (10) is suited to static shapes, it cannot describe the **M** dynamics, such as the one of **M** interacting with **F**. In fact, as **M** is deformed, it will also stretch: as a result, Eq. (10) must be replaced by a time-dependent gauge—see below.

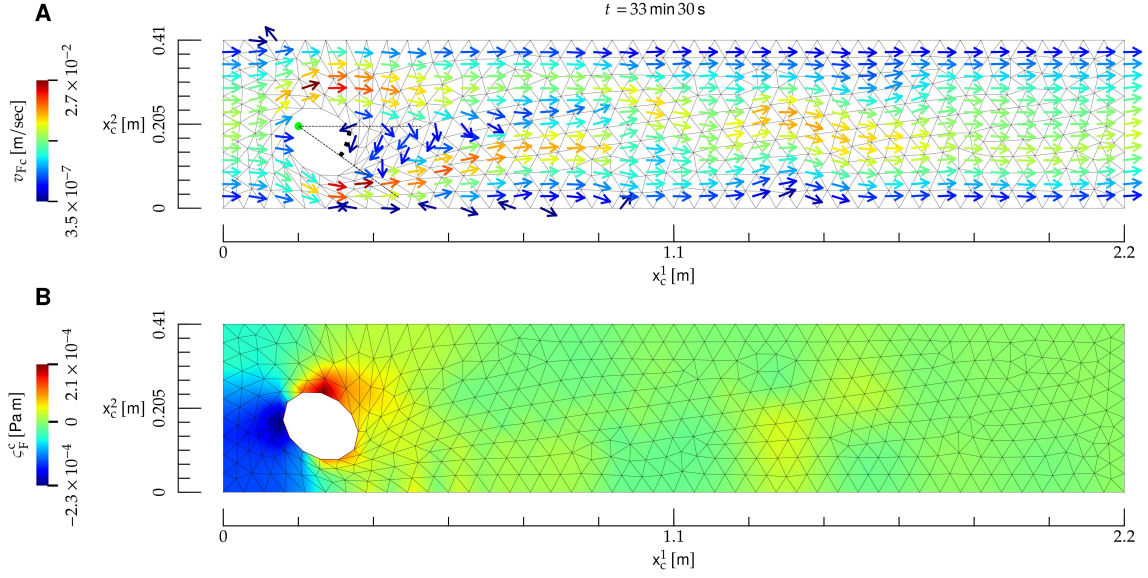


FIG. 1: Interaction between a **bulk fluid (F)** and a rigid **rigid body (R)**, whose material properties roughly correspond to air (**F**) and an aerogel (**R**). **A**) Temporal snapshot of the mesh (black lines) and velocity field (arrows) at the **current** time t , shown on top. The direction of the velocity field is indicated by the arrows, and its norm by their color; the direction of arrows with velocity close to zero is not defined. Here, **R** (ellipse) is allowed to pivot about its left focal point (red dot), and the related angle with respect to the x_{c1} direction is denoted by a red arc. Here, the Reynolds number is $R \sim 2 \times 10^2$. **B**) Color map of the surface tension at the **current** instant of time t .

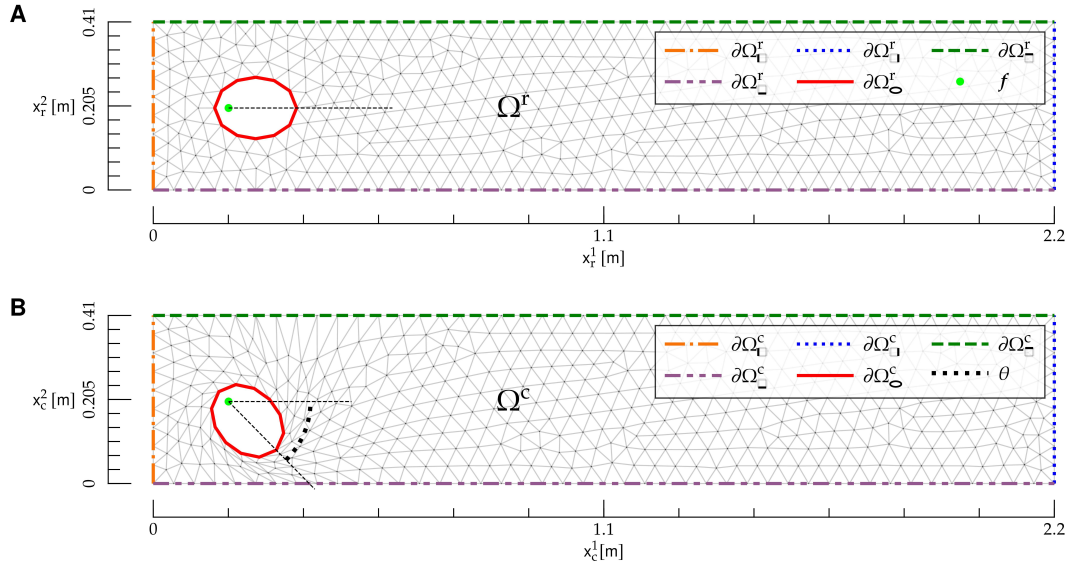


FIG. 2: **Reference (r)** and **current (c)** configuration for the interaction between a **bulk fluid** and a **rigid body (R)**. **A**) **r** configuration. The region Ω^r is given by the rectangle $0 \leq x_r^1 \leq L$, $0 \leq x_r^2 \leq h$ with the elliptical hole (**R**), and is delimited by the mesh (gray lines). Boundaries in the **r** configuration are denoted by $\partial\Omega_L^r$, $\partial\Omega_U^r$, $\partial\Omega_D^r$, $\partial\Omega_B^r$ and $\partial\Omega_\Omega^r$ (colored dashed lines). The ellipse focal point $\mathbf{f}$ (light green dot) is also shown. **B**) **c** configuration. The region Ω^c is delimited by the mesh (gray lines). Boundaries in the **c** configuration are denoted by $\partial\Omega_L^c$, $\partial\Omega_U^c$, $\partial\Omega_D^c$, $\partial\Omega_B^c$ and $\partial\Omega_\Omega^c$ (colored dashed lines), and the rotational angle θ of **R** is shown as an arc (black dotted line). The Cartesian coordinates $\mathbf{x}_c$ are also shown.

along the lines of the description of **D** in Section II A

We describe **M** with the Lagrangian approach,

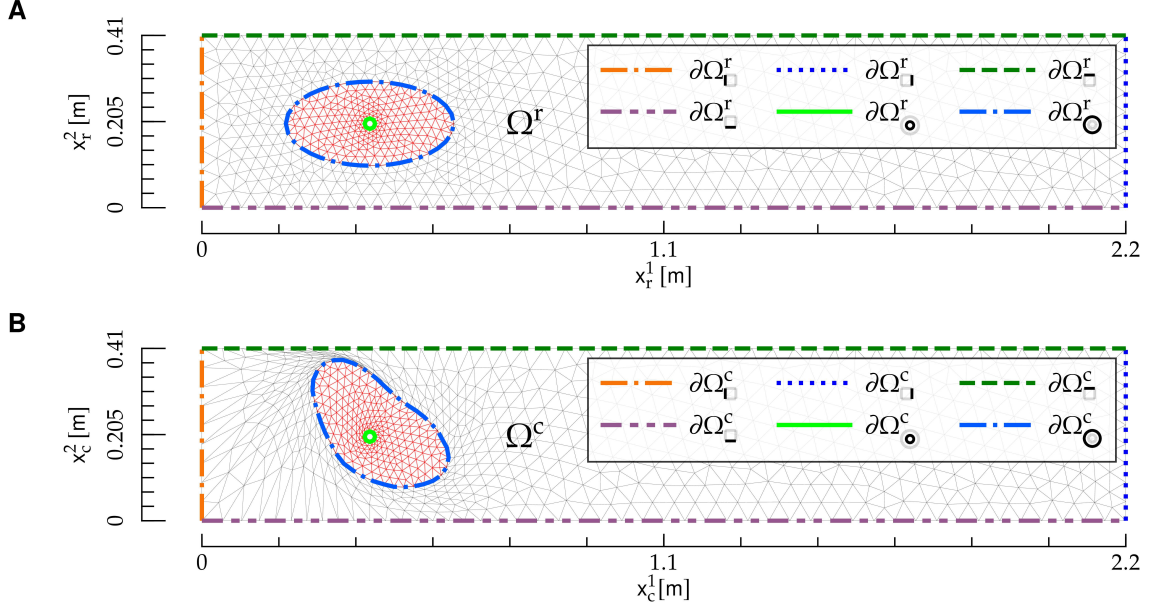


FIG. 3: Reference and current configuration for the interaction between a bulk fluid and an elastic body. The figures follows the same notation as Fig. 2.

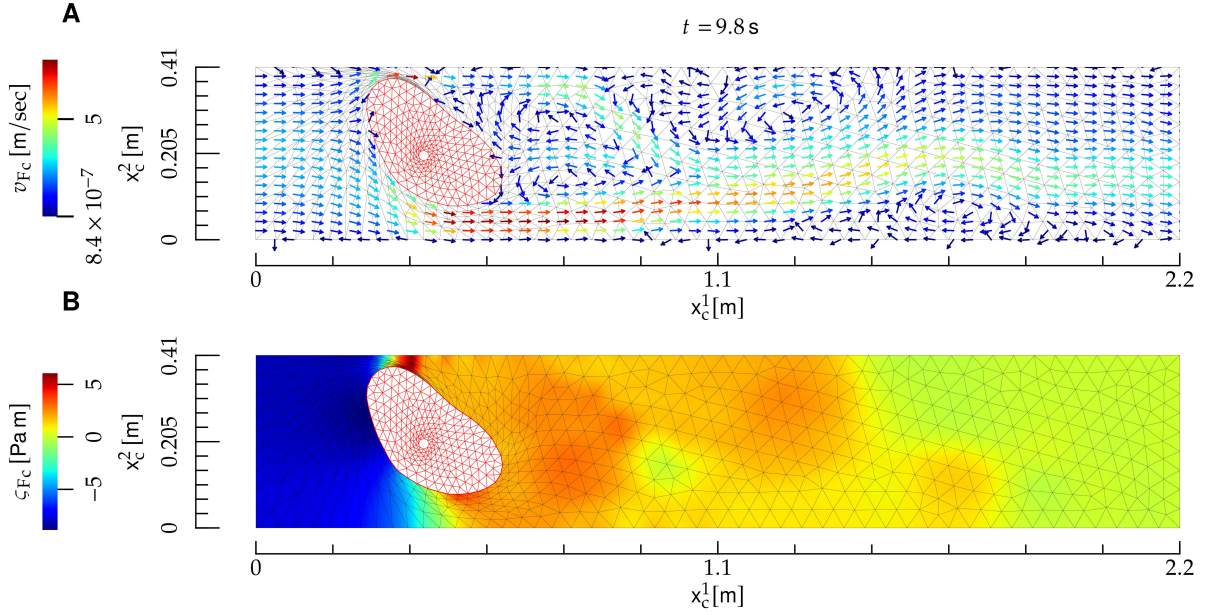


FIG. 4: Interaction between a bulk fluid and an elastic body (E) (a hydrogel). The notation is the same as in Fig. 1, and the elastic body is depicted as a red mesh. Here, the Reynolds number is $R \sim 2 \times 10^2$. The E deformation is not symmetric under the mirror symmetry $x_{c2} \rightarrow h - x_{c2}$, where h is the height of the F domain, because the center of E is not located at $x_{c2} = h/2$.

and E in Appendix B. The M displacement field is

$$\mathbf{u}_M(x^1) \equiv \mathbf{x}_c^M(x^1) - \mathbf{x}_r^M(x^1), \quad (11)$$

where we choose the r configuration as a straight

line

$$\mathbf{x}_r^M(x^1) \equiv (x^1, h), \quad 0 \leq x^1 \leq L, \quad (12)$$

which is shown in Fig. 5A. In addition, we introduce the angle ψ formed by the tangent to M with the

x^1 axis [14], defined by

$$e_1^1 = \nu \cos \psi, \quad (13)$$

$$e_1^2 = -\nu \sin \psi. \quad (14)$$

Finally, the $\mathbf{M}$ metric tensor is defined by [19]

$$g_{ij} \equiv \mathbf{e}_i \cdot \mathbf{e}_j. \quad (15)$$

In what follows, latin indices $i, j, k, \dots$ will be used to denote vectors and tensors related to the $\mathbf{M}$ manifold; their position as upper and lower indexes is thus important [19]. Because the differential manifold of $\mathbf{M}$ is one dimensional, indexes $i, j, k, \dots$ may take only one value, i.e., $i = j = k = \dots = 1$. However, in formal relations such as Eq. (15), we will use the general notation $i, j, k, \dots$ for the sake of generality, and for potential extensions of such relations to two-dimensional manifolds [33].

In order to work out the dynamical equations for $\mathbf{M}$, let us derive the force exerted by $\mathbf{F}$ on $\mathbf{M}$. The

force exerted on a line element dl_c of $\mathbf{M}$ is [18]

$$f_{F\alpha}(\sigma_F^c, \nu, \psi) = -\sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^c \hat{n}^{c\gamma}(\nu, \psi), \quad (16)$$

where

$$\sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^c \equiv \varsigma_F^c \delta_{\alpha\beta} + \eta_F \left(\frac{\partial v_{F\alpha}^c}{\partial x_c^\beta} + \frac{\partial v_{F\beta}^c}{\partial x_c^\alpha} \right) \quad (17)$$

is the $\mathbf{F}$ stress tensor [18] and $\hat{n}^c$ the unit normal to $\partial\Omega_-^c$ pointing outside Ω^c , see Fig. 5. In Eq. (16), σ_F^c is evaluated at the $\mathbf{c}$ coordinate $\mathbf{x}_c^M \in \partial\Omega_-^c$ corresponding to x^1 . The components of the force (16) tangential and normal to $\mathbf{M}$ are [33]

$$f_{Ft}^i(\sigma_F^c, \nu, \psi) = g^{ij}(\nu) e_j^\alpha(\nu, \psi) f_{F\alpha}(\sigma_F^c, \nu, \psi) \quad (18)$$

$$f_{Fn}(\sigma_F^c, \nu, \psi) = \hat{n}^{c\alpha}(\nu, \psi) f_{F\alpha}(\sigma_F^c, \nu, \psi), \quad (19)$$

where in Eq. (18) we used the feature that the metric tensor depends on ν only, see Eqs. (8) and (15).

The equations of motion for $\mathbf{M}$ are [1, 31, 34]

$$\nabla_i v_M^i - 2Hw_M = 0, \quad (20)$$

$$\rho_M \left(\frac{\partial v_M^i}{\partial t} + v_M^j \nabla_j v_M^i - 2v_M^j w_M b_j^i - w_M \nabla^i w_M \right) = \nabla^i \varsigma_M + f_{\eta_M t}^i + f_{Ft}^i, \quad (21)$$

$$\rho_M \left[\frac{\partial w_M}{\partial t} + v_M^i (v_M^j b_{ji} + \nabla_i w_M) \right] = 2\varsigma_M H + f_\kappa + f_{\eta_M n} + f_{Fn}, \quad (22)$$

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{u}_M}{\partial t} = w_M \hat{n}^c, \quad (23)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^1}{\partial x^1} = -1 + \nu \cos \psi, \quad (24)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^2}{\partial x^1} = -\nu \sin \psi, \quad (25)$$

and they hold for $x^1 \in \Omega_-^r$. Here, v_M^i and w are the $\mathbf{M}$ tangential and normal velocity, respectively, ∇ is the covariant derivative related to the Levi-Civita connection associated to g , ∇_{LB} the Laplace-Beltrami operator, b the second fundamental form, and H and K the mean and Gaussian curvature, respectively. We refer to [1, 19, 31, 33] for details on the differential-geometry formulation, and we will now discuss each line in Eqs. (20) to (25). Equation (20) enforces mass conservation [18]. Equations (21) and (22) are the tangential and normal components of the Navier-Stokes (NS)

equations, respectively. The first term in the right-hand side (RHS) of Eq. (21) represents the force on membrane elements induced by gradients of line tension, while the first term in the RHS of Eq. (22) constitutes Laplace pressure [18, 35]. The other terms read

$$f_\kappa(\nu, \psi) \equiv \quad (26)$$

$$-2\kappa[\nabla_i \nabla^i H + 2H(H^2 - K)],$$

$$f_{\eta_M t}^i(v_M, w_M, \nu, \psi) \equiv \quad (27)$$

$$\eta_M[-\nabla_{LB} v_M^i -$$

$$\begin{aligned}
& 2(b^{ij} - 2H g^{ij}) \nabla_j w_M + 2K v_M^i, \\
& f_{\eta_M n}(v_M, w_M, \nu, \psi) \equiv \\
& 2\eta_M[(\nabla^i v_M^j) b_{ij} - 2w_M(2H^2 - K)].
\end{aligned} \tag{28}$$

In Eq. (26), f_κ represents the resistance of $\mathbf{M}$ to bending, and it is derived from Helfrich model [29], while $f_{\eta_M t}$ and $f_{\eta_M n}$ in Eqs. (27) and (28) are, respectively, the tangential and normal component of the viscous force resulting from in-membrane flows [1]. Equation (23) is the time-evolution equation for the $\mathbf{M}$ shape, which evolves according to the normal $\hat{n}^c$, and it has been obtained from Eqs. (11) and (12). Equations (24) and (25) re-express the definitions of ν and ψ , and they result from Eqs. (9) and (11) to (14). Finally, ρ_M , ς_M and κ are, respectively, the density, line tension and bending rigidity of $\mathbf{M}$.

We choose the following **boundary conditions** (BCs) for Eqs. (20) to (25):

$$v_M^i = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \tag{29}$$

$$v_M^i = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{- \bullet}^r, \tag{30}$$

$$w_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \tag{31}$$

$$\nabla_i w_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{- \bullet}^r, \tag{32}$$

$$\varsigma_M = \varsigma_{M\bullet-} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \tag{33}$$

$$\mathbf{u}_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \tag{34}$$

$$u_M^1 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{- \bullet}^r, \tag{35}$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^2}{\partial x^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r. \tag{36}$$

Equations (29), (31) and (34) enforce the condition that the left extremity of $\mathbf{M}$, $\partial\Omega_{\bullet-}$, is clamped on the channel wall $\partial\Omega_{\square}$. Equations (30), (32), (35) and (36) enforce the mirror symmetry about $\partial\Omega_{\square}$. Namely, Eq. (30) ensures that the v_M vector field vanishes on $\partial\Omega_{\bullet-}$, because a nonzero value of this field on $\partial\Omega_{\square}$ would break the axial symmetry. The condition (35) follows the same lines. In addition, the symmetry requires that scalar fields and vertical components of vector fields in Ω have zero slope with respect to x^1 at $\partial\Omega_{\bullet-}$, see Eqs. (32) and (36). Finally, Eq. (33) fixes the $\mathbf{M}$ tension on $\partial\Omega_{\bullet-}$.

2. Bulk fluid domain motion

We will determine $\mathbf{u}_D$ as the solution of a **boundary-value problem** (BVP) given by the following elastic model [15, 36]

$$\frac{\partial S_{D\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D)}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^r, \tag{37}$$

where the elastic stress tensor S_D is given by

$$S_{D\alpha\beta} \equiv F_{\alpha\gamma} T_{\gamma\beta}, \tag{38}$$

and

$$T_{\alpha\beta} \equiv K(\mathbf{u}_D) E_{\gamma\gamma} \delta_{\alpha\beta} + \tag{39}$$

$$2\mu(\mathbf{u}_D) \left(E_{\alpha\beta} - \frac{1}{2} \delta_{\alpha\beta} E_{\gamma\gamma} \right),$$

$$E_{\alpha\beta} \equiv \frac{1}{2} (F_{\gamma\alpha} F_{\gamma\beta} - \delta_{\alpha\beta}), \tag{40}$$

$$K(\mathbf{u}) \equiv \frac{1}{[\det(F(\mathbf{u}))]^\zeta}, \tag{41}$$

$$\mu(\mathbf{u}) \equiv \frac{1}{[\det(F(\mathbf{u}))]^\zeta}. \tag{42}$$

In Eqs. (41) and (42), we included an additional dependence of bulk modulus K and the shear modulus μ on the deformation-gradient tensor (2). In the absence of this dependence, the elastic model above would be unstable under local compression [15]. In fact, the model's Lagrangian would not penalize configurations with small $\det F$. The inclusion of the dependence (41) and (42) on $\det F$ allows for penalizing these configurations—the larger the exponent $\zeta > 0$, the stronger the penalty. As a result, this dependence makes the model stable under mesh compression, such as the one shown below **R** in Fig. 2B.

The equation of motion for $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$ is obtained by deriving Eq. (37) with respect to time, and using the fact that $\mathbf{r}$ coordinates are time independent:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\beta} \frac{dS_{D\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D)}{dt} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^r. \tag{43}$$

We impose the following **BCs** for Eqs. (37) and (43):

$$\mathbf{u}_D = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \tag{44}$$

$$u_D^1 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \tag{45}$$

$$\frac{\partial u_D^2}{\partial x_r^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \tag{46}$$

$$\mathbf{u}_D = \mathbf{u}_M \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \tag{47}$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \tag{48}$$

$$\dot{u}_D^1 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \tag{49}$$

$$\frac{\partial \dot{u}_D^2}{\partial x_r^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \tag{50}$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_M \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r. \tag{51}$$

Equation (44) ensures that $\mathbf{D}$ is not deformed on $\partial\Omega_{\square}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\square}^r$, cf. Eq. (A18). Equations (45) and (46) follow from axial symmetry, and Eq. (47) from the requirement that $\mathbf{D}$ and $\mathbf{M}$ deformations stay conforming [15]. Finally, the **BCs** for $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_M$, Eqs. (48)

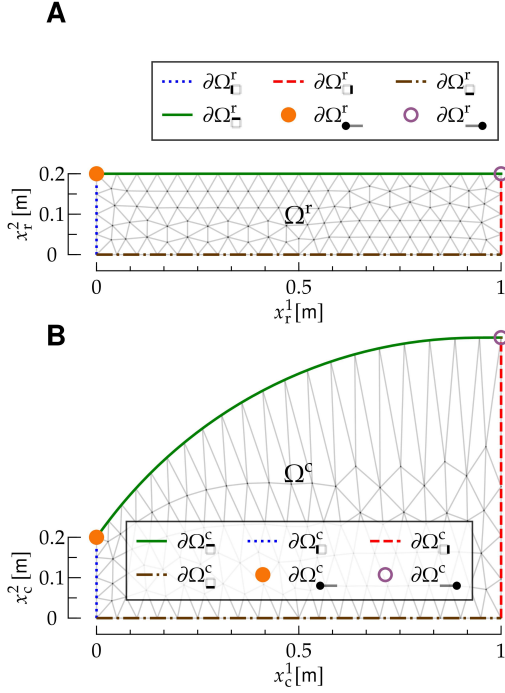


FIG. 5: Reference and current configuration for the interaction between a bulk fluid (F) and a Helfrich membrane (M). The Figure follows the same notation as Fig. 2, and it represents a vertical channel with mirror symmetry about its mid axis, which coincides with $\partial\Omega_{\text{A}}$; the right, mirrored part of the channel is not shown. The top edge of the F mesh, $\partial\Omega_{\text{F}}^{\text{r}}$, coincides with the one-dimensional manifold $\Omega_{\text{M}}^{\text{r}}$ of M.

to (51), are derived along the same lines as Eqs. (44) to (47).

We observe that Eqs. (38) to (42) imply that Eqs. (37) and (43) contains up to second derivatives of $\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\text{D}}$. As a result, the BCs (44) to (51) uniquely determine the solution of the BVP (37) and (43) [37].

3. Bulk fluid motion

We will now discuss the F equations of motion, and present them first in c configuration coordinates, and then transform them in r coordinates.

a. Equations of motion in current configuration coordinates In c coordinates, the F equations of motion are the NS and continuity equations [18]:

$$\rho_{\text{F}} \left(\partial_t v_{\text{F}_c}^{\alpha} + v_{\text{F}_c}^{\beta} \frac{\partial v_{\text{F}_c}^{\alpha}}{\partial x_c^{\beta}} \right) = \frac{\partial \sigma_{\text{F}}^{\alpha\beta}}{\partial x_c^{\beta}}, \quad (52)$$

$$\frac{\partial v_{\text{F}_c}^{\alpha}}{\partial x_c^{\alpha}} = 0, \quad (53)$$

and they hold for $\mathbf{x}_c \in \Omega^c$. Equations (52) and (53) describe the F motion in a flat, two-dimensional geometry [18]—an example of the corresponding NS equations on a curved geometry is given by Eq. (21).

We enforce the following BCs for Eqs. (52) and (53):

$$\mathbf{v}_{\text{F}_c} = \mathbf{v}_{\text{F}_{\square}} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (54)$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{\text{F}_c} = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\text{I}}^c, \quad (55)$$

$$v_{\text{F}_c}^1 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\text{I}}^c, \quad (56)$$

$$\frac{\partial v_{\text{F}_c}^2}{\partial x_c^2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\text{I}}^c, \quad (57)$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{\text{F}_c}(\mathbf{x}_c) = \frac{d\mathbf{u}_{\text{M}}(x^1)}{dt} \Big|_{x^1=[\psi^t(\mathbf{x}_c)]^1} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (58)$$

$$\varsigma_{\text{F}}^c = \varsigma_{\text{F}_{\square}} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c. \quad (59)$$

According to Eq. (54), F is injected from the bottom edge of Ω^c , $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$, while Eq. (55) is a no-slip BC on the left wall $\partial\Omega_{\text{I}}^c$, and Eqs. (56) and (57) result from symmetry. Equation (58) ensures that the motion of F is conforming to that of M [15]: In fact, Eq. (23) ensures that M only moves normally to its profile, and Eq. (58) thus ensures that F stays in contact with M throughout its motion. On the other hand, Eq. (58) implies a tangential slip between M and F, allowing for the tangential part of the F and M velocities to differ. Finally, Eq. (59) stems from the presence of the reservoir, in which the F tension is equal to $\varsigma_{\text{F}_{\square}}$: At the boundary $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$ between the channel and the reservoir, the F tension matches the reservoir's.

b. Equations of motion in reference configuration coordinates We will now rewrite the equations of motion and the BCs of Section II C 3 a in terms of $\mathbf{v}_{\text{F}_r}$, ς_{F}^r , and the r coordinate $\mathbf{x}_r$. The equations of motion (52) and (53) yield, respectively,

$$\rho_{\text{F}} \left\{ \frac{\partial v_{\text{F}_r}^{\alpha}(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial t} + \left[v_{\text{F}_r}^{\gamma}(\mathbf{x}_r, t) - \frac{d\varphi^{\gamma t}(\mathbf{x}_r)}{dt} \right] G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_{\text{D}}^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{\text{F}_r}^{\alpha}(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial x_r^{\beta}} \right\} = \quad (60)$$

FIG. 6: Interaction between a **bulk fluid** (**F**) and a **Helfrich membrane** (**M**). Here, **F** is air, and **M** an elastomer, and the **F** Reynolds number is $R \sim 200$. **A)** **Reference** (**r**) and **current** (**c**) configuration of **M** (red and green curve, respectively), and **M** displacement field $\mathbf{u}_M$ (black arrows). **B)** Stretch field of **M**. **C)** Tangent angle of **M**. **D)** and **E)**: **F** velocity and tension, respectively; the notation is the same as in Fig. 1. **F)**, **G)** and **H)**: Tangential velocity, normal velocity and tension of **M**, respectively. All panels refer to the same instant of time, shown on top, and they display also the deformed mesh (gray lines).

$$G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial \varsigma_F^r(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta} + \eta_F G_{\delta\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\delta} \left[G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\gamma} \right],$$

$$G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r, t)}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta} = 0, \quad (61)$$

which hold in Ω^r . In Eqs. (60) and (61) the tensor G is given by the inverse of F [15]:

$$G_{\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}) \equiv [F(\mathbf{u})]_{\alpha\beta}^{-1}. \quad (62)$$

tion method for **NS** equations [12, 38] with the **arbitrary Lagrangian-Eulerian** (**ALE**) formulation, by discretizing the dynamical equations for **M**, **D** and **F**. The dynamics of the system is obtained as follows.

Following the **CN** temporal-discretization scheme [38], we define fields at staggered, integer and semi-integer time steps [12]: For example, we set

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n(\mathbf{x}_r) \equiv \mathbf{v}_{F_r}(\mathbf{x}_r, t_n), \quad (63)$$

$$\varsigma_F^{n-1/2}(\mathbf{x}_r) \equiv \varsigma_F^r\left(\mathbf{x}_r, \frac{t_n + t_{n-1}}{2}\right), \quad (64)$$

4. Temporal discretization

To numerically solve for the dynamics in a time span $0 \leq t \leq T$, we discretize time by setting $\Delta t \equiv T/N$, $t_n \equiv n \Delta t$, with $n = 0, 1, \dots, N$.

We combine the **Crank Nicolson** (**CN**) discretiza-

and similarly for other **F** and **M** fields.

a. Helfrich membrane We discretize Eqs. (20) to (25) as follows

$$\nabla_i^{n-1/2} v_M^i - 2H^{n-1/2} w_M^n = 0, \quad (65)$$

$$\rho_M \left(\frac{v_M^{n,i} - v_M^{n-1,i}}{\Delta t} + \frac{3}{2} v_M^{n-1,j} \nabla_j^{n-1/2} v_M^{n-1,i} - \frac{1}{2} v_M^{n-2,j} \nabla_j^{n-1/2} v_M^{n-2,i} - 2 v_M^{n-1,j} w_M^{n-1} b_j^{n-1/2,i} - \right. \quad (66)$$

$$\left. w_M^{n-1} \nabla^{n-1/2,i} w_M^{n-1} \right) =$$

$$\nabla^{n-1/2,i} \varsigma_M^{n-1/2} + f_{\eta_M}^i \left(\frac{\mathbf{v}_M^n + \mathbf{v}_M^{n-1}}{2}, \frac{w_M^n + w_M^{n-1}}{2}, \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2} \right) +$$

$$f_{F_t}^i(\sigma_F^r(\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}, \varsigma_F^{n-3/2}, \mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}), \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}),$$

$$\rho_M \left(\frac{w_M^n - w_M^{n-1}}{\Delta t} + v_M^{n-1,i} v_M^{n-1,j} b_{ji}^{n-1/2} + \frac{3}{2} v_M^{n-1,i} \nabla_i^{n-1/2} w_M^{n-1} - \frac{1}{2} v_M^{n-2,i} \nabla_i^{n-1/2} w_M^{n-2} \right) = \quad (67)$$

$$f_\kappa(\nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}) + 2\varsigma_M^{n-1/2} H^{n-1/2} + f_{\eta_M} \left(\frac{\mathbf{v}_M^n + \mathbf{v}_M^{n-1}}{2}, \frac{w_M^n + w_M^{n-1}}{2}, \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2} \right) +$$

$$f_{F_n}(\sigma_F^r(\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}, \varsigma_F^{n-3/2}, \mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}), \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}),$$

$$\frac{\mathbf{u}_M^{n-1/2} - \mathbf{u}_M^{n-3/2}}{\Delta t} = w_M^{n-1} \hat{n}^c n^{-1/2}, \quad (68)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^{n-1/2,1}}{\partial x^1} = -1 + \nu^{n-1/2} \cos \psi^{n-1/2}, \quad (69)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^{n-1/2,2}}{\partial x^1} = -\nu^{n-1/2} \sin \psi^{n-1/2}. \quad (70)$$

In Eqs. (66) and (67), σ_F^r denotes the **F** stress tensor in the **r** configuration:

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^{r,t}(\mathbf{x}_r) &\equiv \sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^c(\varphi^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \\ &= \varsigma_F^r(\mathbf{x}_r, t) \delta_{\alpha\beta} + \eta_F \left[G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F\gamma}^c}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\gamma} + \right. \\ &\quad \left. G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F\gamma}^c}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\gamma} \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (71)$$

Proceeding along the same lines, the discrete

form of the **BCs** (29) to (36) reads, respectively,

$$v_M^{n,i} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (72)$$

$$v_M^{n,i} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (73)$$

$$w_M^n = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (74)$$

$$\nabla_i^{n-1/2} w_M^n = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (75)$$

$$\varsigma_M^{n-1/2} = \varsigma_{M\bullet-} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (76)$$

$$\mathbf{u}_M^{n-1/2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (77)$$

$$u_M^{n-1/2,1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r, \quad (78)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^{n-1/2,2}}{\partial x^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet-}^r. \quad (79)$$

In what follows, we will split the **BVP** into three steps [12, 13]:

1. **Approximated velocities.** Proceeding along the lines of the splitting scheme for **F** of Appendix A 4 b, we introduce the auxiliary velocities $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_M$ and $\bar{w}_M$, which approximate, respectively, $\mathbf{v}_M^n$ and w_M^n [13]. We define $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_M$ and $\bar{w}_M$ as solutions of the **PDEs**

$$\rho_M \left[\frac{\bar{v}_M^i - v_M^{n-1,i}}{\Delta t} + \left(\frac{3}{2} v_M^{n-1,j} - \frac{1}{2} v_M^{n-2,j} \right) \nabla_j^{n-1/2} V_M^i - 2V_M^j W_M b^{n-1/2,j} - W_M \nabla^{n-1/2,i} W_M \right] = \quad (80)$$

$$\begin{aligned} &\nabla^{n-1/2,i} \varsigma_M^* + f_{\eta_M,t}^i \left(\mathbf{V}_M, W_M, \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2} \right) + \\ &f_{Ft}^i(\varsigma_F^r(\mathbf{v}_{Fr}^{n-1}, \varsigma_F^{r,n-3/2}, \mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}), \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}), \end{aligned}$$

$$\rho_M \left[\frac{\bar{w}_M - w_M^{n-1}}{\Delta t} + V_M^i V_M^j b_{ji}^{n-1/2} + \left(\frac{3}{2} v_M^{n-1,i} - \frac{1}{2} v_M^{n-3/2,i} \right) \nabla_i^{n-1/2} W_M \right] = \quad (81)$$

$$\begin{aligned} &f_\kappa(\nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}) + 2\varsigma_M^* H^{n-1/2} + f_{\eta_M,n}(\mathbf{V}_M, W_M, \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}) + \\ &f_{Fn}(\varsigma_F^r(\mathbf{v}_{Fr}^{n-1}, \varsigma_F^{r,n-3/2}, \mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}), \nu^{n-1/2}, \psi^{n-1/2}), \end{aligned}$$

where we have set

$$V_M^i \equiv \frac{\bar{v}_M^i + v_M^{n-1,i}}{2}, \quad (82)$$

$$W_M \equiv \frac{\bar{w}_M + w_M^{n-1}}{2}, \quad (83)$$

$$\varsigma_M^* \equiv \varsigma_M^{n-3/2}, \quad (84)$$

Equations (80) and (81) are the analog of Eqs. (66) and (67), respectively, with a fixed pressure field ς_M^* from the preceding step—in what follows, we will synonymously use the

terms ‘pressure’ and ‘tension’ for conciseness [31].

Overall, Eqs. (80) and (81) determine $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_M$ and $\bar{w}_M$.

2. **Pressure correction.** Subtracting Eqs. (66) and (80) and neglecting $\mathcal{O}(\Delta t)$ [31], we obtain

$$\rho_M \frac{v_M^{n,i} - \bar{v}_M^i}{\Delta t} = -\nabla^{n-1/2,i} \phi_M, \quad (85)$$

where we have defined the pressure increment

as

$$\phi_M \equiv \varsigma_M^* - \varsigma_M^{n-1/2}. \quad (86)$$

Proceeding along the same lines for Eqs. (67) and (81), we obtain

$$w_M^n = \bar{w}_M. \quad (87)$$

By taking the covariant derivative of Eq. (85) and using the mass-conservation equation (65) and Eq. (87), we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla_i^{n-1/2} \nabla^{n-1/2, i} \phi_M = \quad (88) \\ \frac{\rho_M}{\Delta t} (\nabla_i^{n-1/2} \bar{v}_M^i - 2H^{n-1/2} \bar{w}_M). \end{aligned}$$

Equation (88) is a second-order PDE which determines ϕ_M , and thus the tension $\varsigma_M^{n-1/2}$ through Eq. (86).

3. Velocity correction. The $\mathbf{M}$ velocity $\mathbf{v}_M^n$ is determined by means of Eq. (88) in terms of $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_M$ and ϕ_M .

The BCs for Eqs. (68) to (70), (80), (81), (85), (87) and (88) are

$$\bar{v}_M^i = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet}^r, \quad (89)$$

$$\bar{v}_M^i = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet}^r, \quad (90)$$

$$\bar{w}_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet}^r, \quad (91)$$

$$\nabla_i^{n-1/2} \bar{w}_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet}^r, \quad (92)$$

$$\phi_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet}^r, \quad (93)$$

$$n_{Mi}^{n-1/2} \nabla^{n-1/2, i} \phi_M = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet}^r, \quad (94)$$

$$\mathbf{u}_M^{n-1/2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet}^r, \quad (95)$$

$$u_M^{n-1/2, 1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet}^r, \quad (96)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_M^{n-1/2, 2}}{\partial x^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\bullet}^r. \quad (97)$$

In Eq. (94), $\mathbf{n}_M$ is the unit normal to $\partial\Omega_{\bullet}^r$: It lies in the tangent bundle of $\Omega_{\bullet}^r$, it is directed outside $\Omega_{\bullet}^r$, and it is normalized according to $n_M^i n_{Mi} = 1$ [19, 31, 39].

b. Bulk fluid domain The discretization of the equations of motion for $\mathbf{D}$ proceeds along the same lines as in Section II A, see Appendix A 4 c. The discrete version of the PDEs (37) and (43) is

$$\frac{\partial S_{D\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^n)}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^r, \quad (98)$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\beta} \frac{dS_{D\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^n)}{dt} = 0 \text{ in } \Omega^r, \quad (99)$$

with BCs given by the discrete version of Eqs. (44) to (51):

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (100)$$

$$u_D^{n, 1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (101)$$

$$\frac{\partial u_D^{n, 2}}{\partial x_t^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (102)$$

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{u}_M^{n-1/2} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (103)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (104)$$

$$\dot{u}_D^{n, 1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (105)$$

$$\frac{\partial \dot{u}_D^{n, 2}}{\partial x_t^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (106)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \mathbf{u}_M^{n-1/2} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r. \quad (107)$$

c. Bulk fluid The discretization of the equations of motion for $\mathbf{F}$ proceeds along the same lines as in Section II A, and is split into three steps: Approximated velocity, pressure correction and velocity correction, see Appendix A 4 b.

The resulting PDEs for $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F$ and ς_F^r are

$$\rho_F \left\{ \frac{\bar{v}_F^\alpha - v_{Fr}^{n-1, \alpha}}{\Delta t} + \left[\frac{3}{2} (v_{Fr}^{n-1, \gamma} - \dot{u}_D^{n-1, \gamma}) G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) - \frac{1}{2} (v_{Fr}^{n-2, \gamma} - \dot{u}_D^{n-2, \gamma}) G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-2}) \right] \frac{\partial V_F^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\beta} \right\} = \quad (108)$$

$$\begin{aligned} G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \varsigma_F^{r*}}{\partial x_r^\beta} + \eta_F G_{\delta\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\delta} \left(G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial V_F^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\gamma} \right), \\ \frac{\rho_F}{\Delta t} G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \bar{v}_F^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\gamma} = \end{aligned} \quad (109)$$

$$G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\gamma} \left(G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta} \right),$$

where we have set

$$\mathbf{V}_F \equiv \frac{\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F + \mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}}{2}, \quad (110)$$

$$\zeta_F^{r*} \equiv \zeta_F^{r n-3/2}, \quad (111)$$

$$\phi_F \equiv \zeta_F^{r*} - \zeta_F^{r n-1/2}. \quad (112)$$

The BCs for Eqs. (108) and (109) are [12]

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F = \mathbf{v}_{F_\square} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r, \quad (113)$$

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r, \quad (114)$$

$$\bar{v}_F^1 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r, \quad (115)$$

$$G(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})_{\alpha 1} \frac{\partial V_F^2}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\alpha} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r, \quad (116)$$

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F(x^1, h) = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_M^{n-1/2}(x^1) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r, \quad (117)$$

$$\phi_F = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r, \quad (118)$$

$$\hat{n}^r \gamma G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta} = \quad (119)$$

$$0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r \cup \partial\Omega_\square^r,$$

$$G(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})_{\alpha 1} \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\alpha} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_\square^r. \quad (120)$$

Finally, $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n$ is determined from $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F$ and $\zeta_F^{r n-1/2}$ by means of the relation

$$\rho_F \frac{\bar{v}_F^\alpha - v_{F_r}^{n, \alpha}}{\Delta t} = G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta} \text{ in } \Omega^r. \quad (121)$$

Given the **M** fields $v_M^{n-1, i}$, $w_M^{n-1, i}$, $\zeta_M^{n-3/2}$, $\mathbf{u}_M^{n-3/2}$, $\nu^{n-3/2}$, $\psi^{n-3/2}$, the **D** fields $\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}$, $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^{n-1}$, and the **F** fields $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}$, $\zeta_F^{r n-3/2}$, we determine the fields at the next time step $n \rightarrow n+1$ as follows:

- **Update M.** The **M** fields $v_M^{n, i}$, $w_M^{n, i}$, $\zeta_M^{n-1/2}$, $\mathbf{u}_M^{n-1/2}$, $\nu^{n-1/2}$, $\psi^{n-1/2}$ are determined by solving the BVP given by Eqs. (68) to (70), (80), (81), (85) and (87) to (97).

- **Update D.** We determine the **D** displacement field and its time derivative, $\mathbf{u}_D^n$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n$, from the BVPs given by Eqs. (98) to (107).

- **Update F.** We determine the **F** fields $\mathbf{v}_M^n$ and $\zeta_F^{r n-1/2}$ by solving the BVP given by Eqs. (108), (109) and (113) to (120), and by solving Eq. (121).

The fields $\mathbf{v}_{F_c}^n$, $\zeta_F^{c n-1/2}$ in the **c** configuration are then obtained from the respective fields in the **r** configuration through Eqs. (5) and (6).

An example of this dynamics is shown in Fig. 6, where we show the interaction between air (**F**) and an elastomer (**M**). The channel has dimensions $L = 1$ m, $h = 0.2$ m. Proceeding along the lines of Section II A, **M** parameters have been estimated by considering the parameters for a three-dimensional material, multiplying them by a unit length corresponding to the out-of-plane depth, and by the **M** thickness, chosen to be $\Delta = 10^{-3}$ m. The **M** bending rigidity κ has been estimated from the relation $\kappa = E\Delta^3/[12(1-\nu^2)]$, which expresses κ as a function of the Young modulus E , the Poisson ratio ν , and Δ [16]. Typical values for an elastomer are $E \sim 10^7$ Pa [40] and $\nu \sim 0.5$ [41], yielding $\kappa = 10^{-3}$ Kg m³/sec². We chose $\rho_M = 1$ Kg/m and $\eta_M = 1$ Kg m/sec as the density and viscosity of an elastomer, respectively [42, 43], and we take $\zeta_{M_\bullet} = 1$ N. The **F** parameters have been estimated from the air parameters: $\rho_F = 1$ Kg/m², $\eta_F = 10^{-5}$ Kg/sec [23]. Also, we take $\zeta_{F_\square} = -1$ N/m², and $\mathbf{v}_{F_\square}^1 = 0$, $\mathbf{v}_{F_\square}^2(\mathbf{x}_c) = \frac{3}{2L^2} \mathbf{x}_{c1}(2L - \mathbf{x}_{c1})v_0$, where $v_0 = 10^{-2}$ m/sec, and $\mathbf{v}_{F_\square}^2$ corresponds to a Poiseuille flow [18]. Finally, the **D** exponent is $\zeta = 3$ [15].

III. DISCUSSION

The **M** shape shown in Fig. 7 has a curvature which varies along the **M** profile, and thus differs from the classical circle-arc obtained at the interface between two fluids [18, 35].

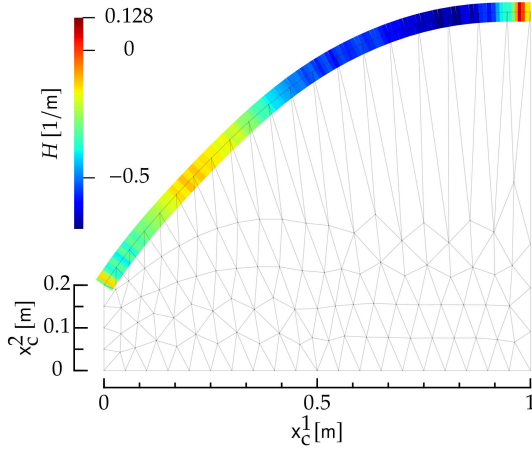


FIG. 7: Curvature of the **Helfrich membrane** interacting with a **bulk fluid** shown in Fig. 6. The Figure follows the same notation and it corresponds to the same instant of time as Fig. 6.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

We would like to thank S. Al-Izzi and S. Astruc for useful discussions, and the **finite element computational software** (**FEniCS**) online community for its precious support.

This work was granted access to the high-performance computing resources of MesoPSL financed by the Region Île de France, and to the Abacus cluster at Institut Curie.

Appendix A: Fluid and rigid body

1. Rigid body motion

In this Section, we will work out the equations of motion for **R**.

a. Equation of motion in **current**-configuration coordinates

The dynamics of **R** is given by the equations of motion for a rigid body which, in **c** coordinates, read [44]

$$I \frac{d\omega}{dt} = - \int_{\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}} dl_c \epsilon_{3\alpha\beta} \sigma_{\mathbf{F}\beta\gamma}^c \hat{n}^{c\gamma}, \quad (\text{A1})$$

$$\omega \equiv \frac{d\theta}{dt}. \quad (\text{A2})$$

Equation (A1) relates the angular acceleration of **R** to the torque of external forces. The moment of inertia of **R** is denoted by I . The **right-hand side** (RHS) of Eq. (A1) contains the line integral along the boundary of **R**, of the torque of the local force exerted by **bulk fluid** (**F**) on **R** with respect to the left focal point **f** of **R** [18], and $\hat{n}^c$ is the normal to $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}$ pointing towards Ω^c .

This force is expressed in terms of the **F** stress tensor [18] in **c** coordinates $\sigma_{\mathbf{F}}^c$, given by Eq. (17), where $\eta_{\mathbf{F}}$ and $\rho_{\mathbf{F}}$ are the two-dimensional viscosity and density of **F**, respectively. Also, $\epsilon_{\alpha\beta\gamma}$ is the three-dimensional Levi-Civita symbol. Finally, dl_c is the line element of $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}$ in the **c** configuration, and $\hat{n}^c$ the unit boundary normal to $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}$ pointing outside Ω^c .

b. Equation of motion in the **reference**-configuration coordinates

In **r** coordinates, Eq. (A1) reads

$$I \frac{d\omega}{dt} = \int_{\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{r}}} ds \epsilon_{\alpha\beta} [\varphi^{\alpha,t}(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)) - f^{\alpha}] \sigma_{\mathbf{F}\beta\gamma}^r(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)) \epsilon_{\gamma\lambda} F_{\lambda\mu}(\mathbf{u}_{\mathbf{D}}^t(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s))) \frac{d\xi^{\mu}(s)}{ds}. \quad (\text{A3})$$

In Eq. (A3), the integral in the **RHS** is over the curvilinear boundary $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}^r$, which is parametrized as $\mathbf{x}_r = \boldsymbol{\xi}(s)$, where s is the curvilinear coordinate. Also, $\epsilon_{\alpha\beta}$ is the two-dimensional Levi-Civita symbol [19], and σ_F^r denotes the stress tensor in the **r** configuration, which is given by Eq. (71), where G is given by Eq. (62).

2. Fluid motion

In this Section, we will work out the equations of motion for **F**.

a. Equations of motion in the *current*-configuration coordinates

The equations of motion, expressed in terms of the **c** fields v_{F_c} and ς_F^c , are Eqs. (52) and (53), see Section IIC 3 for details.

The **boundary conditions** (BCs) for Eqs. (52), (53), (A1) and (A2) are

$$v_{F_c}^1(\mathbf{x}_c) = v_{F_{\square}} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (\text{A4})$$

$$v_{F_c}^2(\mathbf{x}_c) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (\text{A5})$$

$$v_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_c) = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (\text{A6})$$

$$v_{F_c}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_c) = \frac{d[R(\theta)]_{\alpha\beta}}{dt} [\psi^{t\beta}(\mathbf{x}_c) - f^\beta] \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}^c, \quad (\text{A7})$$

$$\eta_F \frac{\partial v_{F_c}^\alpha}{\partial x_c^1} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c, \quad (\text{A8})$$

$$\varsigma_F^c(\mathbf{x}_c) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^c. \quad (\text{A9})$$

Equations (A4) and (A5) ensure that **F** is injected on the boundary $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$ in a direction parallel to the x_{c1} axis, and Eq. (A6) is a no-slip BC [18] along the channel walls $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$, see Fig. 2. Equation (A7) ensures that, at the boundary $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}^c$, the **F** velocity matches the rotational velocity of **R**. Given that **R** can only rotate about its left focal point **f**, the **R** rotational velocity of a point $\mathbf{x}_c \in \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}^c$ is given by

$$\frac{d[R(\theta)]_{\alpha\beta}}{dt} [\psi^{t\beta}(\mathbf{x}_c) - c_\beta], \quad (\text{A10})$$

where **R** is the rotation matrix corresponding to a counterclockwise rotation:

$$\mathbf{R}(\theta) \equiv \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix}. \quad (\text{A11})$$

Finally, Eqs. (A8) and (A9) ensure, respectively, that on $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$ there is zero traction and tension; this corresponds to the hypothesis that there is free flow at $\partial\Omega_{\square}^c$ [12, 18].

b. Equations of motion in the *reference*-configuration coordinates

We will now rewrite the equations of motion and the BCs in terms of v_{F_r} , ς_F^r , and the **r** coordinate $\mathbf{x}_r$. The equations of motion (52) and (53) yield, respectively, Eqs. (60) and (61), see Section IIC 3 b. The BCs (A4) to (A9) yield as

$$v_{F_r}^1(\mathbf{x}_r) = v_{F_{\square}} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A12})$$

$$v_{F_r}^2(\mathbf{x}_r) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A13})$$

$$v_{F_r}(\mathbf{x}_r) = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A14})$$

$$v_{F_r}^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r) = \frac{d[R(\theta)]_{\alpha\beta}}{dt} (x_r^\beta - f^\beta) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}^r, \quad (\text{A15})$$

$$\eta_F G_{\beta 1}(\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r)) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A16})$$

$$\varsigma_F^r(\mathbf{x}_r) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r. \quad (\text{A17})$$

3. Motion of bulk fluid domain

The equations of motion (60), (61), (A3) and (A12) to (A17) involve the displacement field $\mathbf{u}_D$, which describes how the region—or domain—which contains **F**, is deformed in time, cf. Fig. 2. We will denote this region as the **D**. We observe that this field has, so far, been left arbitrary, and we have the freedom to choose it.

Here, $\mathbf{u}_D$ will be determined with an analogy with the theory of elasticity [15]. We imagine that, as **R** rotates about its focal point, each point $\mathbf{x}_r \in \Omega^r$ moves into a point $\mathbf{x}_c \in \Omega^c$, and that the domain Ω^r is deformed, e.g., locally stretched and compressed, into Ω^c , like an elastic medium. We will determine $\mathbf{u}_D$ as the solution of a **boundary-value problem** (BVP) given by the elastic model (37), see Section IIC 2 for details.

The BCs for the **partial differential equation** (PDE) (37) are

$$\mathbf{u}_D = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A18})$$

$$\mathbf{u}_D = \mathbf{f} - \mathbf{x}_r + \mathbf{R}(\theta) \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}^r. \quad (\text{A19})$$

Equation (A18) enforces the fact that the mesh is not deformed at the boundary $\partial\Omega_{\square}^r$. Finally, Eq. (A19) ensures that the mesh deformation at $\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{c}}^r$ matches the deformation induced by the rotation of **R**.

Equations (37), (A18) and (A19) constitute the **BVP** which determines $\mathbf{u}_D$. Along the lines of

BVPs in the theory of elasticity, such BVP is already, naturally formulated in the $\mathbf{r}$ configuration [16].

From the BVP above, we obtain a BVP for $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{D}}$, which will be needed in the following to describe the $\mathbf{D}$ motion. By deriving both sides of Eqs. (37), (A18) and (A19), we obtain, respectively, Eq. (43) and

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{D}} = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (\text{A20})$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{D}} = \omega \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}} - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}, \quad (\text{A21})$$

where in Eqs. (A20) and (A21) we used the fact that $\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}$ is independent of time, and in Eq. (A21) we substituted Eq. (A2). The left-hand side (LHS) of Eq. (43) depends on the second partial derivatives of $\mathbf{u}_{\mathbf{D}}$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{D}}$ —see Eqs. (38) to (42). As a result, given θ , ω , and $\mathbf{u}_{\mathbf{D}}$ from Eqs. (37), (A18) and (A19), the BVP (43), (A20) and (A21) determines $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{D}}$.

Overall Eqs. (37), (43), (60), (61), (A2), (A3) and (A12) to (A21) constitute a BVP for $\theta, \omega, \mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}}, \zeta_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{r}}, \mathbf{u}_{\mathbf{D}}$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_{\mathbf{D}}$ which, combined with the temporal BCs

$$\theta(t=0) = \theta_0 \quad (\text{A22})$$

$$\frac{\theta^n - \theta^{n-1}}{\Delta t} = \omega^n, \quad (\text{A26})$$

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\omega^n - \omega^{n-1}}{\Delta t} = & I \int_{\partial\Omega_{\mathbf{D}}^{\mathbf{r}}} ds \epsilon_{\alpha\beta} [\xi^{\alpha}(s) + u^{n-1, \alpha}(\xi(s)) - f^{\alpha}] \sigma_{\mathbf{F}\beta\gamma}^{\mathbf{r}^{n-1}}(\xi(s); \mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}}^{n-1}, \zeta_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{r}^{n-3/2}}) \times \\ & \epsilon_{\gamma\lambda} F_{\lambda\mu}(\mathbf{u}_{\mathbf{D}}^{n-1}(\xi(s))) \frac{d\xi^{\mu}(s)}{ds}, \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A27})$$

where in Eq. (A27) we used Eqs. (1) and (3) and we explicitly indicated the dependence of the stress tensor (71) on $\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{c}}$ and $\zeta_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{c}}$.

b. Bulk fluid

To discretize in time the $\mathbf{F}$ problem, we will apply the CN splitting scheme [12, 38] to the NS equations

$$\omega(t=0) = \omega_0 \quad (\text{A23})$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}}(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}, t=0) = \mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}0}(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}), \quad (\text{A24})$$

$$\zeta_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{r}}(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}, t=0) = \zeta_{\mathbf{F}0}^{\mathbf{r}}(\mathbf{x}_{\mathbf{r}}), \quad (\text{A25})$$

determine the dynamics of the system.

4. Temporal discretization

To numerically solve for the dynamics in a time span $0 \leq t \leq T$, we discretize time by setting $\Delta t \equiv T/N$, $t_n \equiv n \Delta t$, with $n = 0, 1, \dots, N$.

We combine the Crank Nicolson (CN) discretization method for Navier-Stokes (NS) equations [12, 38] with the arbitrary Lagrangian-Eulerian (ALE) formulation, by discretizing the dynamical equations for $\mathbf{R}$, $\mathbf{F}$ and $\mathbf{D}$ —see below.

a. Rigid body

Proceeding along the lines of the CN scheme [38], we define fields at staggered, integer and semi-integer time steps [12]—see for example Eqs. (63)

and (64) for $\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{F}\mathbf{r}}$ and $\zeta_{\mathbf{F}}^{\mathbf{r}}$ —and similarly for other quantities. We discretize Eqs. (A2) and (A3) and, neglecting $\mathcal{O}(\Delta t)$, we obtain

(60) and (61) in the $\mathbf{r}$ configurations. This splitting scheme is derived from the incremental pressure correction scheme [45], in which the solution of the NS equations is split into three intermediate steps. In what follows, we will synonymously use the terms ‘pressure’ and ‘surface tension’ for conciseness [31].

The discrete form of the PDEs Eqs. (60) and (61) is

$$\rho_F \left[\frac{v_{F_r}^{n,\alpha} - v_{F_r}^{n-1,\alpha}}{\Delta t} + \frac{3}{2} (v_{F_r}^{n-1,\gamma} - \dot{u}^{n-1,\gamma}) G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^{n-1,\alpha}}{\partial x_r^\beta} - \frac{1}{2} (v_{F_r}^{n-2,\gamma} - \dot{u}^{n-2,\gamma}) \times \right. \quad (\text{A28})$$

$$\left. G_{\beta\gamma}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-2}) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^{n-2,\alpha}}{\partial x_r^\beta} \right] = G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \zeta_F^{r,n-1/2}}{\partial x_r^\beta} + \eta_F G_{\delta\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\delta} \left[G_{\gamma\beta}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\gamma} \left(\frac{v_{F_r}^{n,\alpha} + v_{F_r}^{n-1,\alpha}}{2} \right) \right],$$

$$G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial v_{F_r}^{n,\alpha}}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0, \quad (\text{A29})$$

where we omitted the dependence on $\mathbf{x}_r$ for clarity. Also, in the LHS of Eq. (A28) we rewrote the convective term according to the Adams-Bashforth discretization scheme [12, 46], and we used Eqs. (1)

and (3) to rewrite the time derivative of φ in terms of $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$.

The discrete form of the BCs (A12) to (A17) reads

$$v_{F_r}^{n,1} = \mathbf{v}_{F_\square} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A30})$$

$$v_{F_r}^{n,2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A31})$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A32})$$

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_r} = \omega^n \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \Big|_{\theta=\theta_n} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\odot}^r, \quad (\text{A33})$$

$$\eta_F G_{\beta 1}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial}{\partial x_r^\beta} \left(\frac{v_{F_r}^{n,\alpha} + v_{F_r}^{n-1,\alpha}}{2} \right) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A34})$$

$$\zeta_F^{r,n-1/2} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r. \quad (\text{A35})$$

We will now split the BVP into three steps [12, 13]:

1. Approximated velocity. We introduce the velocity $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F$, which approximates the true velocity $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}$, and which satisfies the BVP given by Eq. (108) and BCs

$$\bar{v}_F^1 = \mathbf{v}_{F_\square} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A36})$$

$$\bar{v}_F^2 = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A37})$$

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r, \quad (\text{A38})$$

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F = \omega^n \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \Big|_{\theta=\theta_n} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\odot}^r, \quad (\text{A39})$$

$$\eta_F G_{\beta 1}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial V_F^\alpha}{\partial x_r^\beta} = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\square}^r. \quad (\text{A40})$$

where $\mathbf{V}_F$ and ς_F^* are given by Eqs. (110) and (111).

2. Pressure correction.

Subtracting Eqs. (108) and (A28) and neglecting $\mathcal{O}(\Delta t)$, we obtain Eq. (121), where the surface-tension increment ϕ_F is defined by Eq. (112). By applying $G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})\partial/\partial x_r^\gamma$ to both sides of Eq. (121) and using Eq. (A29), we obtain the second-order PDE (109) for ϕ_F .

We will now work out the BCs for Eq. (109). Equations (111), (112) and (A35) imply the BC

$$\phi_F = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r. \quad (\text{A41})$$

Multiplying Eq. (121) by $G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})\hat{n}^{\gamma\gamma}$, where $\hat{n}^{\gamma}$ is the unit boundary normal in the $\mathbf{r}$ configuration, we obtain

$$\frac{\rho_F}{\Delta t} G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1})\hat{n}^{\gamma\gamma}(\bar{v}_F^\alpha - v_{F_r}^{n,\alpha}) = \quad (\text{A42})$$

$$\hat{n}^{\gamma\gamma} G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial x_r^\beta}.$$

Combining Eq. (A42) with Eqs. (A30) to (A33) and (A36) to (A39), we obtain the second BC

$$\hat{n}^{\gamma\gamma} G_{\gamma\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) G_{\beta\alpha}(\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}) \frac{\partial \phi_F}{\partial x_r^\beta} = \quad (\text{A43})$$

$$0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r \cup \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r.$$

The BVP (109), (A41) and (A43) determines ϕ_F and, through the definition (112), the surface tension $\varsigma_c^{n-1/2}$.

3. **Velocity correction.** The velocity $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n$ is determined from the approximate velocity $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F$ from Eq. (121).

c. Bulk fluid domain

The discrete version of the BVP for $\mathbf{u}_D$, Eqs. (37), (A18) and (A19), is given by Eq. (98) and

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r, \quad (\text{A44})$$

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{f} - \mathbf{x}_r + \mathbf{R}(\theta^n) \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r. \quad (\text{A45})$$

The discrete version of the BVP for $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D$, Eqs. (43), (A20) and (A21), is given by Eq. (99) and

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \mathbf{0} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r, \quad (\text{A46})$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \omega \frac{d\mathbf{R}}{d\theta} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{f}) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\Gamma}^r. \quad (\text{A47})$$

We can now iterate in time for the ensemble of fields of the $\mathbf{F}$ - $\mathbf{R}$ system as follows. At each step n , given θ^{n-1} , ω^{n-1} , $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}$, $\varsigma_F^{n-3/2}$, $\mathbf{u}_D^{n-1}$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^{n-1}$ from the preceding step, we

1. **Update $\mathbf{R}$.** Solve the algebraic equations Eqs. (A26) and (A27) for θ^n and ω^n .
2. **Update $\mathbf{D}$.** Solve the BVPs (98), (99) and (A44) to (A47) for $\mathbf{u}_D^n$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n$.
3. **Update $\mathbf{F}$.** Solve the BVPs (108) and (A36) to (A40) and (A41) to (A43) for $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F$ and $\varsigma_F^{n-1/2}$, and obtain $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^n$ from Eq. (121).

The fields $\mathbf{v}_{F_c}^{n-1}$, $\varsigma_F^{c,n-3/2}$ in the $\mathbf{c}$ configuration are then obtained from the respective fields in the $\mathbf{r}$ configuration through Eqs. (5) and (6).

5. Characteristic time scale

As shown in Fig. 8, the dynamics of Fig. 1 involves a characteristic time scales τ_B , i.e., the period of the angular oscillations of $\mathbf{B}$. This time scale can be estimated by considering the dynamical equation (A1) for $\mathbf{B}$, and approximating its LHS as I/τ_B^2 and its RHS as $(\eta_F v_0/a) 2\pi a$. Here, $\eta_F v_0/a$ is the viscous component of the force per unit length exerted by $\mathbf{F}$ on $\mathbf{B}$, cf. Eq. (17), $2\pi a$ estimates the total length of the boundary of $\mathbf{B}$, and a approximates the lever arm of the force above. Putting everything together, we obtain

$$\tau_B \sim \sqrt{\frac{I}{2\pi a \eta_F v_0}}. \quad (\text{A48})$$

For the parameters of Fig. 1, Eq. (A48) yields $\tau_B \sim 130$ sec, which is in agreement with the period of the oscillations in Fig. 8.

Appendix B: Fluid and elastic body

1. Equations of motion

The equations of motion for the dynamics of $\mathbf{F}$ and elastic body (E) are the following.

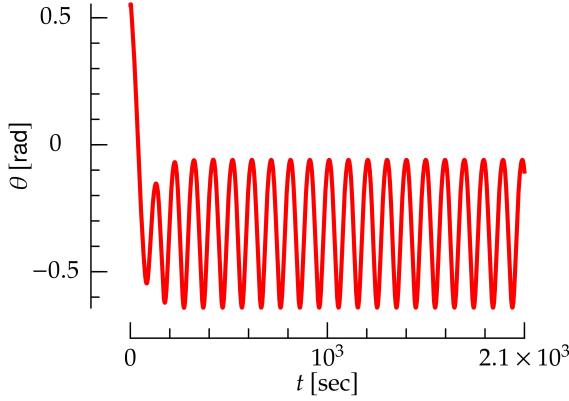


FIG. 8: Angle of the rigid body as a function of time for the interaction between a bulk fluid and a rigid body shown in Fig. 1.

First, the dynamics of **F** is governed by the NS and mass-conservation equations (52) and (53), respectively. Their BCs are Eqs. (A4) to (A6), (A8) and (A9), which stay unchanged with respect to Section II A. On the other hand, BC (A7), which ensures that the **F** velocity matches the **B** velocity at the interface between **F** and **B**, now reads

$$\mathbf{v}_{F_c}(\mathbf{x}_c) = \left. \frac{d\mathbf{u}_E(\mathbf{x}_r)}{dt} \right|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\psi^t(\mathbf{x}_c)} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathcal{O}}^c \quad (\text{B1})$$

Second, the motion of **E** is governed by Newton's equations of motion for an elastic body [16]

$$\rho_E \frac{d^2 \mathbf{u}_E^\alpha(\mathbf{x}_r)}{dt^2} = \frac{\partial S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E)}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta}, \quad (\text{B2})$$

where ρ_E is the density of **E**, which is assumed to be independent of space. Also, $\mathbf{u}_E$ is the deformation field of **E**, which is defined along the lines of Eq. (1). The **E** stress tensor is derived from a compressible neo-Hookean model [47], and it reads

$$S_{E\alpha\beta} \equiv \frac{\mu}{\det F} \left(-\frac{1}{2} C_{\gamma\gamma} G_{\alpha\beta} + F_{\beta\alpha} \right) + K[(\det(F))^2 - 1] G_{\alpha\beta}, \quad (\text{B3})$$

where

$$C_{\alpha\beta} \equiv \delta_{\alpha\beta} + 2E_{\alpha\beta}. \quad (\text{B4})$$

We have chosen this model because it is stable under compression, i.e., its potential energy diverges as $\det F \rightarrow 0$ [47]. As opposed to linear models [16] and to the elastic model of Appendix A 3, this model proves to yield a stable dynamics for **E** as

it is compressed by **F**, see below and Fig. 4. The BCs for Eq. (B2) are

$$\mathbf{u}_E(\mathbf{x}_r) = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathcal{O}}^r, \quad (\text{B5})$$

$$S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E^t)|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)} \epsilon_{\beta\gamma} \frac{d\xi^\gamma}{ds} = \sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^c(\boldsymbol{\varphi}^t(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s))) \epsilon_{\beta\gamma} \frac{d\varphi^{t,\gamma}(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s))}{ds} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathcal{O}}^r. \quad (\text{B6})$$

In the LHS of Eq. (B6), the quantity $\epsilon_{\beta\gamma} \frac{d\xi^\gamma}{ds}$ represents the unit normal to $\partial\Omega_{\mathcal{O}}^r$, and similarly for the RHS.

Finally, the equations of motion for **D** are (37) and (43), with BCs (A18) and (A20) and

$$\mathbf{u}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r) = \mathbf{u}_E^t(\mathbf{x}_r) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathcal{O}}^r, \quad (\text{B7})$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^t(\mathbf{x}_r) = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^t(\mathbf{x}_r) \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathcal{O}}^r. \quad (\text{B8})$$

Equation (B7) and Eq. (B8) ensure that the displacement and velocity of **E** and **D** are conforming at the **E-D** interface, and they replace Eqs. (A19) and (A21), respectively.

2. Dynamics

The system dynamics is obtained as follows: given $\mathbf{v}_{F_r}^{n-1}$, $\zeta_F^{n-3/2}$, $\mathbf{u}_E^{n-1}$, $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^{n-1}$, $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^{n-1}$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^{n-1}$ from the preceding step, we

- **Update E.** Solve for $\mathbf{u}_E^n$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^n$ the discrete version of Eq. (B2)

$$\rho_E \frac{\dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^{n,\alpha} - \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^{n-1,\alpha}}{\Delta t} = \frac{\partial S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E^n)}{\partial \mathbf{x}_r^\beta}, \quad (\text{B9})$$

$$\frac{\mathbf{u}_E^n - \mathbf{u}_E^{n-1}}{\Delta t} = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E, \quad (\text{B10})$$

with BCs obtained from Eqs. (B5) and (B6):

$$\mathbf{u}_E^n = 0 \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathcal{O}}^r, \quad (\text{B11})$$

$$\epsilon_{\beta\gamma} S_{E\alpha\beta}(\mathbf{u}_E^n)|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)} \frac{d\xi^\gamma}{ds} = \sigma_{F\alpha\beta}^r(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s); \mathbf{v}_{Fr}^{n-1}, \varsigma_F^{r\,n-3/2}, \mathbf{u}_E^n) \epsilon_{\beta\gamma} F_{\gamma\delta}(\mathbf{u}_E^{n-1})|_{\mathbf{x}_r=\boldsymbol{\xi}(s)} \frac{d\xi^\delta}{ds} \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r. \quad (\text{B12})$$

In Eq. (B12), we have used Eqs. (2) and (3) to rewrite the derivative of $\phi(\boldsymbol{\xi}(s))$.

- **Update D.** Solve for $\mathbf{u}_D^n$ and $\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n$ the BVPs given by Eqs. (98) and (99) with BCs (A44), (A46) and

$$\mathbf{u}_D^n = \mathbf{u}_E^n \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r, \quad (\text{B13})$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{u}}_D^n = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^n \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r. \quad (\text{B14})$$

- **Update F.** Solve the BVPs given by (108) and (109) and BCs (A36) to (A38), (A40), (A41) and (A43) and

$$\bar{\mathbf{v}}_F = \dot{\mathbf{u}}_E^n \text{ on } \partial\Omega_{\mathbf{O}}^r, \quad (\text{B15})$$

which replaces Eq. (A40) for a rigid body, and solve Eq. (121).

-
- [1] M. Arroyo and A. DeSimone, Relaxation dynamics of fluid membranes, *Phys. Rev. E* **79**, 031915 (2009).
 - [2] G. Boedec, M. Leonetti, and M. Jaeger, Isogeometric FEM-BEM simulations of drop, capsule and vesicle dynamics in Stokes flow, *Journal of Computational Physics* **342**, 117 (2017).
 - [3] H. Zhou, Y.-N. Young, and Y. Mori, *Modeling and Simulation of Open Membranes in Stokes Flow with Mixed-Dimensional Coupling* (2026), arXiv:2504.16823 [math].
 - [4] J. M. Barakat and E. S. G. Shaqfeh, Stokes flow of vesicles in a circular tube, *J. Fluid Mech.* **851**, 606 (2018).
 - [5] D. S. Rodrigues, R. F. Ausas, F. Mut, and G. C. Buscaglia, A semi-implicit finite element method for viscous lipid membranes, *Journal of Computational Physics* **298**, 565 (2015).
 - [6] A. Bonito, R. Nochetto, and M. Pauletti, Dynamics of Biomembranes: Effect of the Bulk Fluid, *Math. Model. Nat. Phenom.* **6**, 25 (2011).
 - [7] A. Bonito, R. H. Nochetto, and M. Sebastian Pauletti, Parametric FEM for geometric biomembranes, *Journal of Computational Physics* **229**, 3171 (2010).
 - [8] A. Laadhari, Finite-Element Method for the Simulation of Lipid Vesicle/Fluid Interactions in a Quasi-Newtonian Fluid Flow, *Mathematics* **11**, 1950 (2023).
 - [9] J. W. Barrett, H. Garcke, and R. Nürnberg, Finite element approximation for the dynamics of asymmetric fluidic biomembranes, *Math. Comp.* **86**, 1037 (2016).
 - [10] L. E. Malvern, *Introduction to the Mechanics of a Continuous Medium* (Prentice Hall, Englewood Cliffs, NJ, 1969).
 - [11] P. Howell, G. Zoyreff, and J. Ockendon, *Applied Solid Mechanics* (Cambridge University Press, 2008).
 - [12] A. Logg, K.-A. Mardal, and G. Wells, eds., *Automated Solution of Differential Equations by the Finite Element Method: The FEniCS Book*, Lecture Notes in Computational Science and Engineering, Vol. 84 (Springer Berlin Heidelberg, Berlin, Heidelberg, 2012).
 - [13] A. J. Chorin, Numerical solution of the Navier-Stokes equations, *Math. Comp.* **22**, 745 (1968).
 - [14] I. Derényi, F. Jülicher, and J. Prost, Formation and Interaction of Membrane Tubes, *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **88**, 238101 (2002).
 - [15] D. Kamensky, Lecture notes for MAE 207: Finite element analysis for coupled problems (2022).
 - [16] L. D. Landau and E. M. Lifshitz, *Theory of Elasticity* (Elsevier, 1986).
 - [17] W. S. Slaughter, *The Linearized Theory of Elasticity* (Birkhäuser Boston, Boston, MA, 2002).
 - [18] L. D. Landau and E. M. Lifshitz, *Fluid Mechanics* (Pergamon, 1987).
 - [19] S. Marchiafava, *Appunti Di Geometria Differenziale*, Vol. I, II, III (Edizioni Nuova Cultura, 2005).
 - [20] S. S. KISTLER, Coherent Expanded Aerogels and Jellies, *Nature* **127**, 741 (1931).
 - [21] H. Blum, J. Harig., S. Müller, S. Schreiber, and S. Turek, FEAT2D, Finite Element Analysis Tools User Manual (1995).
 - [22] M. Schafer and S. Turek, Benchmark Computations of Laminar Flow Around a Cylinder (1996).
 - [23] J. Hilsenrath, *Tables of Thermal Properties of Gases: Comprising Tables of Thermodynamic and Transport Properties of Air, Argon, Carbon Dioxide, Carbon Monoxide, Hydrogen, Nitrogen, Oxygen, and Steam*, Vol. 564 (US Department of Commerce, National Bureau of Standards, 1955).
 - [24] A.-G. Niculescu, D.-I. Tudorache, M. Bocioagă,

- D. E. Mihaiescu, T. Hadibarata, and A. M. Grumezescu, An Updated Overview of Silica Aerogel-Based Nanomaterials, *Nanomaterials* **14**, 469 (2024).
- [25] S. Xu, Z. Zhou, Z. Liu, and P. Sharma, Concurrent stiffening and softening in hydrogels under dehydration, *Sci. Adv.* **9**, eade3240 (2023).
- [26] G. Rehage, Elastic properties of crosslinked polymers, in *Macromolecular Chemistry-9*, edited by L. Cross (Butterworth-Heinemann, 1974) pp. 161–178.
- [27] C. Licht, J. C. Rose, A. O. Anarkoli, D. Blondel, M. Roccio, T. Haraszti, D. B. Gehlen, J. A. Hubbell, M. P. Lutolf, and L. De Laporte, Synthetic 3D PEG-Anisogel Tailored with Fibronectin Fragments Induce Aligned Nerve Extension, *Biomacromolecules* **20**, 4075 (2019).
- [28] U. Chippada, B. Yurke, and N. A. Langrana, Simultaneous determination of Young’s modulus, shear modulus, and Poisson’s ratio of soft hydrogels, *J. Mater. Res.* **25**, 545 (2010).
- [29] W. Helfrich, Elastic Properties of Lipid Bilayers: Theory and Possible Experiments, *Zeitschrift für Naturforschung C* **28**, 693 (1973).
- [30] O.-Y. Zhong-can and W. Helfrich, Bending energy of vesicle membranes: General expressions for the first, second, and third variation of the shape energy and applications to spheres and cylinders, *Phys. Rev. A* **39**, 5280 (1989).
- [31] D. Wörthmüller, G. Ferraro, P. Sens, and M. Castellana, IRENE: A fluid layer finite-element software, <http://arxiv.org/abs/2506.17827> (2025), [arXiv:2506.17827 \[physics\]](https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.17827).
- [32] C.-C. Hsiung, *A First Course in Differential Geometry* (John Wiley & Sons, New York, USA, 1981).
- [33] M. Deserno, Fluid lipid membranes: From differential geometry to curvature stresses, *Chemistry and Physics of Lipids* **185**, 11 (2015).
- [34] S. C. Al-Izzi, P. Sens, and M. S. Turner, Shear-Driven Instabilities of Membrane Tubes and Dynamin-Induced Scission, *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **125**, 018101 (2020).
- [35] P.-G. De Gennes, F. Brochard-Wyart, and D. Quéré, *Capillarity and Wetting Phenomena* (Springer New York, New York, NY, 2004).
- [36] J. E. Marsden and T. J. R. Hughes, *Mathematical Foundations of Elasticity* (Dover, New York, 1994).
- [37] L. C. Evans, *Partial Differential Equations*, Graduate Studies in Mathematics (American Mathematical Society, 2010).
- [38] J. Crank and P. Nicolson, A practical method for numerical evaluation of solutions of partial differential equations of the heat-conduction type, *Math. Proc. Camb. Phil. Soc.* **43**, 50 (1947).
- [39] H. Reall, General Relativity, <https://www.damtp.cam.ac.uk/user/hsr1000/teaching.html>.
- [40] L. Feng, S. Li, and S. Feng, Preparation and characterization of silicone rubber with high modulus via tension spring-type crosslinking, *RSC Adv.* **7**, 13130 (2017).
- [41] A. Müller, M. C. Wapler, and U. Wallrabe, A quick and accurate method to determine the Poisson’s ratio and the coefficient of thermal expansion of PDMS, *Soft Matter* **15**, 779 (2019).
- [42] L.-H. Cai, T. E. Kodger, R. E. Guerra, A. F. Pegoraro, M. Rubinstein, and D. A. Weitz, Soft Poly(dimethylsiloxane) Elastomers from Architecture-Driven Entanglement Free Design, *Advanced Materials* **27**, 5132 (2015).
- [43] K. V. Pochivalov, A. N. Shilov, T. N. Lebedeva, A. N. Ilyasova, R. Y. Golovanov, A. V. Basko, and Y. V. Kudryavtsev, Development of vibration damping materials based on butyl rubber: A study of the phase equilibrium, rheological, and dynamic properties of compositions, *J of Applied Polymer Sci* **138**, 50196 (2021).
- [44] H. Goldstein, C. P. Poole, and J. L. Safko, *Classical Mechanics* (Pearson, 2004).
- [45] K. Goda, A multistep technique with implicit difference schemes for calculating two- or three-dimensional cavity flows, *Journal of Computational Physics* **30**, 76 (1979).
- [46] *Solving Ordinary Differential Equations I*, Springer Series in Computational Mathematics, Vol. 8 (Springer Berlin Heidelberg, Berlin, Heidelberg, 1993).
- [47] Y. Bazilevs, V. M. Calo, T. J. R. Hughes, and Y. Zhang, Isogeometric fluid-structure interaction: Theory, algorithms, and computations, *Comput Mech* **43**, 3 (2008).